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WEDNESDAY
MARCH 18, 2026
RAMADAN 29, 1447



LIVE
UPDATES

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Israel says Iran's security chief killed

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Israel said yesterday it had killed Iran's powerful national security chief Ali Larijani in a strike Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said targeted the leadership of the Islamic Republic. Iran has not confirmed the claim.

If verified, Larijani's death would mark a major blow to Iran's ruling system more than two weeks into a war that has engulfed the Middle East, roiled global markets and drawn in regional actors.

Larijani, 68, was long seen as a key pillar of the system — close to Ayatollah Ali Khamenei and central to Iran's nuclear policy and strategic diplomacy. Since the war began, his influence had grown. While new supreme leader Mojtaba Khamenei has not appeared in public, Larijani was seen among crowds at a pro-government rally in Tehran last week.

Basij head dead?

Israel also said it killed Gholamreza Soleimani, head of the Basij paramilitary force, in a separate strike in Tehran.

A drone and rocket attack on the US embassy in Baghdad early yesterday highlighted the conflict's spillover across the region.

In Washington, a senior US counterterrorism official resigned in protest, saying Iran posed no imminent threat and criticising the war's rationale.

US President Donald Trump, in remarks on Truth Social, yesterday said Nato allies had declined to join the US-led operation but insisted Washington did not need their support, claiming Iran's military and leadership had been "decimated."

SEE ALSO P7, P-11, III, IV

UAE LEADERS, JORDAN KING CALL FOR A HALT TO ESCALATING MILITARY ACTIONS

Stress the need to prioritise dialogue and diplomacy



■ Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed, Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid and Sheikh Hamdan met King Abdullah II of Jordan on Monday.

ABU DHABI
Gulf News Report

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan on Monday received King Abdullah II of Jordan.

The meeting was attended by His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court and Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed and King Abdullah II, who is on a fraternal visit to the UAE, exchanged greetings and best wishes ahead of Eid Al Fitr, wishing continued wellbeing, prosperity,

and stability for their countries and peoples.

During the meeting, the UAE President and the Jordanian King discussed regional developments in light of the escalating military situation and the serious implications it poses for security and stability in the region. The meeting also addressed the continued Iranian aggression targeting countries in the region, which constitutes a violation of sovereignty and international law and norms and represents a threat to international peace and security.

Jordan's solidarity with UAE

In this context, King Abdullah II reaffirmed Jordan's solidarity with the UAE regarding all measures it is taking to defend its sovereignty and security and ensure the safety of its people.

Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed also affirmed the UAE's solidarity with Jordan in confronting the Iranian attacks targeting its sovereignty and security. Both sides

underscored the importance of an immediate halt to the escalating military actions and the need to prioritise dialogue and diplomacy to address outstanding issues in the region in a way that preserves security and prevents further tensions and crises.

Categorical rejection

Meanwhile, the UAE reaffirmed its categorical rejection of any justifications put forward by the Iranian government regarding the hostile escalation against countries in the region, stressing that such claims are merely attempts to mislead the international community in an effort to justify its unprovoked and unlawful aggression against the UAE and countries in the region.

The statement was delivered by Jamal Al Musharakh, Permanent Representative of the UAE to the United Nations Office and Other International Organisations in Geneva, during the interactive dialogue with the Special

Rapporteur on the situation of human rights in Iran and the Independent International Fact-Finding Mission on Iran at the Human Rights Council's current session in Geneva.

One more killed

Yesterday, the UAE's air defence systems intercepted 10 Iranian ballistic missiles and 45 drones, according to the Ministry of Defence. Authorities in Abu Dhabi responded to an incident caused by falling shrapnel in the Bani Yas area following the interception of a ballistic missile by air defence systems. The incident resulted in the death of a Pakistani national, according to officials.

Air traffic operations have returned to normal across the UAE's airspace, the General Civil Aviation Authority (GCAA) announced. Earlier in the day, UAE authorities temporarily closed the country's airspace as an exceptional precautionary measure.

SEE ALSO P5, 6, 10, 11



IFTAR 18:32
Fajr 05:08 Shuruq 06:21
Dhuhr 12:30 Asr 15:54
Maghrib 18:32 Isha 19:46

IMSAK 04:58
Add 4 minutes for Abu Dhabi, deduct 4 minutes for RAK and 6 minutes for Fujairah



ENTERTAINMENT

Did Chalamet lose the Oscar because of his ballet comments? | P16



SPORT

Iran in talks with Fifa to move its World Cup matches to Mexico | P14

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US-ISRAEL-IRAN WAR



WHY SOME CRUDE OILS ARE MORE VALUABLE

Light, heavy, sweet and sour: how crude grades shape demand and global oil trade | P8-9

UAE extends distance learning in schools

Universities, higher education institutions to also continue remote learning

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

The UAE's education authorities said yesterday that distance learning will continue for two weeks at the start of the third academic term, covering all nurseries, kindergartens, and public and private schools nationwide. Universities and higher education institutions will also continue remote learning for two weeks after spring break ends on March 22.

Authorities will conduct weekly reviews and communicate updates through official school channels, with private

SCHOOLS READY FOR EVERY SCENARIO

School leaders say they are planning carefully for all outcomes as distance learning continues. Simon Crane, Headmaster of Brighton College Dubai, summed up the collective spirit: "Whilst we remain hopeful of a return to in-person schooling in due course, we are planning carefully for all eventualities."

Lisa Johnson, Principal of American Academy for Girls (AAG) added: "There has been a strong sense of calm, care, and cooperation across the community. We have deep respect for and trust in the government's forward-thinking approach."

—S.S.

schools and universities permitted to submit requests for a return to in-person learning based on operational needs. In parallel, the Federal Authority for Government Human Resources has introduced flexible remote work for federal employees who are caregivers of children from nursery through Grade 8, as part of the Year of the Family initiative. The measure applies to fathers or mothers whose job roles

meet the approved requirements for remote work.

Curriculum-based schedule

Meanwhile, GEMS Education, one of the country's largest school operators, laid out a curriculum-specific schedule for its network. International curriculum schools, regardless of regulatory authority, will move to online learning from Monday, March 23.

For Indian curriculum schools — CBSE, ICSE, and ISC — timelines differ by emirate: schools under SPEA in Sharjah and ADEK in Abu Dhabi will transition online from March 30 until April 6, while KHDA-regulated schools in Dubai will begin their new academic year on April 6. All GEMS schools are expected to return to in-person learning from Monday, April 6, in line with guidance from education and regulatory authorities.

GEMS Education assured parents that its schools have "well-established digital platforms, experienced teachers, and structured schedules in place to ensure that learning continues seamlessly." Students will follow regular timetables, attendance and engagement will continue as normal, and academic progress and assessments will remain on track.

SEE ALSO P2